

Lecture #2 Western

Religions.

Documentary Theory or the Hebrew Scriptures

some things to keep in mind.

1. When judging what tradition you are reading you must consider: 1. structure, 2. themes, 3. religious values, 4. literary styles.

The relationship between actual history and what's in the Bible is redacted (edited) by writers over a period of about 500 years for their own theological purposes.

2. the Israelites up until the exile and following were Monolatrist
18 they believed each nation had its own god
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including them. Each god had its own area of territory and one proved their god was the strongest by beating the people of an area and their god.

The cult of the Ark of the Covenant was tied up with this idea. When they went to war, it was carried with them so YHWH would be with them.

3. There were three authority figures in the Hebrew scriptures which were each given priority depending on the writer. These were the prophet, priest and king.
(Janowitz)

Davidic J. written between 1000 and 900
It Davidic and Solomonic

court

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YHWH 3 name known from beginning of
with question of authority

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position

Kings authority is paramount.

Sister/wife anecdote Gen. 12.

Exodus motif. -Abraham and Sarah go to Egypt and then leave.

God intervenes directly to get Sarah out of pharaoh's household.

Abraham gets rich

No concern for Sarah's chastity while in pharaoh's household. -not important.

Covenant Gen. 15.

Promise of land, occasional ritual tho not real important.

Prehistory (only J and P are history)

concerned with primal

Doesn't see world in terms of unfolding of God, begins with natural unfolding of creation--begins for sake of men and women.

Gen. 2:5-4:1 main point is bondage of human life. men involved in hard labor, women in painful

in painful labor.

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J says our problems are because of a falling away from

Law of God (rebellion in eating from the forbidden tree)

(humane dialle being

2. world filled with temptation

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3. humans are cured by being sent out into the world of

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human bondage.

Gen. 4:2-16--Cain and Able--takes over a Babalonian myth of the Goddess (Ishtar) choosing a farmer over a shepherd.

J wants to say that humans can't handle their internal problems

Noah-Gen. 8:20-22-J's flood story theology is that both man and nature are perverse.

J sees human conflict as inevitable, he is anti-urbanization, ritual is a compromise so royal law is necessary.

ritual comes about because humans want to control god and nature--is a compromise between God and man.

Royal Theology

II Sam David's sons are priests-David is a warrior, lawgiver, law executer, priest, prophet as well as king.

II Sam 23:1-7- Special covenant made with David and his family

I Kings 2:1-12--David speaks to Solomon about being the most ruthless king because of covenant.

I Kings 3:4-15--6cd speaks wisdom thru the king.

Eloist known as

Solomon's death

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prophetic theology.

sees history in terms of development of prophecy.

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Abraham> Moses> Joshua> Samuel David> prophets.

Ephraim and Manasse (The Joseph tribes) used name 'Elohim' for God until the Exodus. This strand emphasises prophecy, names and

Aiteology (the beginnings of things.)

Sister/wife anecdote Gen. 20.

Wandering motif, God comes in a vision, Abraham doesn't get rich as in J., Morality is important. Sarah's chastity is pure.

E says a leader becomes a leader only if a prophet chooses him.

Moses seen as prophetic leader.

J and E are thoroughly mixed by about 700 B.C.E. doesn't have an independent view of Moses.

Exodus 3:13-18-- J, E

SO J

God has new name (new for E) YHWH--means new activities God is acting in a new way. New activity is that he is constantly with people.

promise is land, national

greatness name used as

cultic name "ya hu" "he is here"

Exodus 12:21-24, 37-39--cult seen feast of unleavened bread.

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as family ritual--no

chetic view of kace

7:7-28, --Gideon

en oy God

(Sam 2:27-36--600 anoints king thru the prophet.

I Sam 8:1

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22--Anti-kingship speech by Samuel.

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I Sam 15-16--David shows prophetic virtues.

II Sam 12--Nathan and David--Prophet is above king.
 II Kings 9--Elisha foments revolution of Jehu to kill
 Ahab and Jezabel.
 I Sam 15-16--Saul keeps booty
 22-23--Samuel chews him out--point is a king should
 listen to what the prophet tells him.
 Deuteronomist) writer writes in the 7th cent. after the
 fall of the northern kingdom in 722 B.C.E.

What we now have as the book of Deuteronomy was "found"
 by a priest while cleaning the temple in 622 B.C.E. (see II
 Kings 22:8ff)

D sees Josiah as the favorite king because of the reforms
 he brings. He doesn't approve of David so goes to Josiah.

Books whose final redactor was D are Deuteronomy, Judges
 I/II Samuel and I/II Kings.
 example of how a redactor works:

Deut. 26:1-19 is a personal harvest ritual. Vs. 1-11 are
 penned by J concerned with individual person and private
 wealth.

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Seen as king-prototype of leadership

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12-19

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Judges (book) sees cyclic view of history, lawlessness going
 from disaster repentance> victory.

D felt the judges were over all Israel. redacted to show
 must turn back to God for victory.

called "Josianic Compromise" because it wants to see the
 king, the royal priesthood and the royal prophets as equal.
 All others are illegitimate.

II Kings 23--desperate attempt for independence.
 restructure of priest, prophet and king relationship

D renders the Ark of the Covenant obsolete which is good
 since it had probably disappeared by then.

War Theme runs thru all Deuteronomist history. All
 leaders are war leaders. One of ways to determine which
 strand you are reading is in the attitude towards war.

Passover

Is the central mythological symbol for all the strands.
 most important day for all sources because fundamental

holiday for nation because of exodus. Also as individual holiday--essence of social religion.

emphasis on national

beginning.

law

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Excessively and scribal.

scribal. called P. Post

written from Babylon.

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(536 B.C.E.++)

Final redactor for nearly all the books thru Nehemiah. all those not mentioned for D including Genesis, Ex, Lev., Num, Joshua, I/II Chron, Ezra and Nehemiah.

concerned with law, traditions, and ritual. Priestly authority.

Sees history as going from parochial to universal faith. It is with P that henotheism gives way to monotheism.

creation> Noah> Abraham? Moses> Solomon> Hezekiah> Ezra. Covenant-Gen. 17-covenant for promise of covenant ritual of circumcision as everlasting sign.

Moses seen as Priest.

Exodus 6:2-8--more covenant conscious.

1. meaning of YHWH's new name is as covenant seal --first called YHWH in Ex. 6, before that called El Shaddai or the great one.

2. God's nature a covenant observer

3. promise to create a covenant nation, new type of nation land important because of covenant, not because is 'milk and honey' as for J.

Exodus 12:1-28, 40-49--cult of social solidarity. begins important

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circumcision

is note of citizenship.

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Exodus 19: 10-13 Moses as priest giving the ten commandments.

message is:

1. contact with diety is dangerous for people--can only move so close to mountain.
2. priest protects the people from the destructive elements of the divine.
3. Setting up ritual barriers between holy and profane.
4. emphasis is on death penalty--comes to whoever usurps priestly power.

Difference between priest and prophet is that any Israelite could be called to be a prophet but a priest must come from the Levite tribe.

Priest sets up unchanging order

prophet is innovative and brings change.

Ps primal history
non-anecdotal,

not concerned with narrative.

emphasis on D'm t (likeness)

concerned with details

never uses name of YHWH before Moses.

no reference to Cain and Able.

& pattern,

Creation narrative (Ben.

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Fs Biblical Creacion

account culminates in cultic act

--the Sabbath.

Its an event on the Lord's calender, not man's. Nature's natural flow is what it means.

Nature is God's creation, not an independent power in opposition to God.

Man is in likeness of God not made out of blood of God as in Babalonian myth of Tiamut being slain by Marduk.

the history of the world and man is the history of God.

In Babylon, the history of Babylonia is the history of god.

Gen. 5:1-8--Geneology, P emphasizes every 10th generation.

Adam? Noah? Abraham?

F wants to show the progressive decline from the potency of creative act. Then God must give another push.

"theology of the push .

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J

Called

Gen. 6:9-22, 7:6--Flood comes because there is only one
righteous man.

Gen 9:1-18, 28-29--Covenant with Noah is play on words DIT
t-blood and Dm t-image. important. the covenant is a set
contract between man and God . so distance collapsed .
constantly renewed covenant.

P has

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